

dads did, and housing affordability makes it harder to settle into a property and begin to tick off life's milestones.

However, single home ownership is on the rise in Australia. Data collected by lenders shows an increase in individual men and women applying for mortgages, so if you're saving for a deposit alone, know that you are not alone. ME Bank's records indicate that loan applications by single women rose from 17 per cent of all applications in 2012 to more than 19 per cent in 2015; single men grew from 16 per cent to almost 18 per cent. Unless Tinder is suddenly yielding results, against all odds, those figures have surely risen since. Being single isn't always fun, but by not dating you can save so much more money, and that can buy some happiness.

If you decide that strapping on a chastity belt while deposit-saving isn't your style, go ahead and fire up Tinder, Happn and Bumble, because there are ways to date without overspending. Entertaining at home will inject thousands of dollars into your account and is my fallback strategy for being stingy while maintaining some sort of a social life.

Here's a few meals of around \$5 or less per serve from my own Pocket Money Savings Plan recipe book, and menus designed especially for first home savers by top Australian chefs, plus great bottles of wine for \$20 or under, for those with a nose for a top tippie. These suggestions are sure to impress a potential paramour, friends and family, and keep your financial plan steady. And remember – love don't cost a thing.